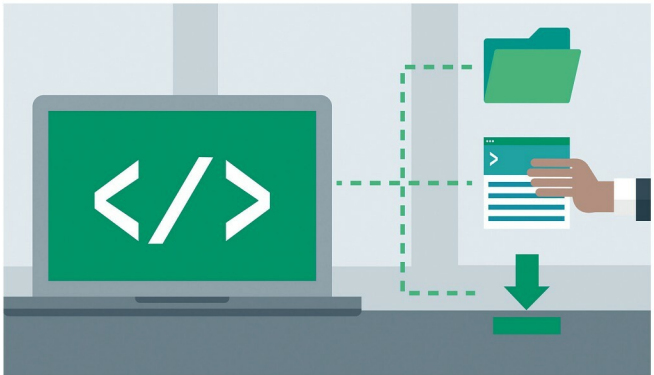


Automate Tasks by Programming with Shell Scripts

Shell scripts are designed to be run on the command line on UNIX based systems. They include commands and instructions to perform specific tasks. Shell scripts are an effective way to create small but efficient programs to carry out and automate OS tasks.



Programming in UNIX has always been a real treat, as it is really programmer-friendly compared to other OSs.

The treat becomes better with some programs that are made up of commands and instructions, which are used to automate many of the tasks in this OS. But there are certain conditions that need to be met in order to get something great. In this case, there is a lot of software and many applications that need to be adjusted and optimised to run on UNIX. This, however, becomes extremely easy with shell scripting. Let's take a brief look at this format of coding.

Understanding shell scripts

Basically, a shell script is a program that includes different commands and instructions. These commands as well as instructions perform tasks, one by one, when run individually. But there are certain things that we do, for which we need to write commands very frequently. This is really time consuming; therefore, we write a program to collectively run these commands and automate tasks.

Another important thing about these programs is that, unlike others, they are not compiled but interpreted. This means that when running the program, a child shell is created. All the operations are performed in that shell, and this child shell terminates itself after the completion of all the tasks in the program.

Customising shell scripts

To customise a shell script, we first need to create it as follows:

- To hold a text program, we need to create a text file
- Choose a shell to write the script
- Add the necessary commands to the file
- Save the file
- Change its permissions to make the file executable
- Run the shell program

For standardisation and portability we use the Bourne shell (sh). For further customisation, there are different types of commands that address almost every aspect of custom scripting. These are: